Phase 1 roadmap, concepts and work breakdown for an on-premises intranet

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The first release of a bilingual intranet that runs entirely on the organization's own isolated network. This page shows what is built, in what order, and how the work breaks down. It is a planning baseline, so it uses week numbers, not dates.

New here? Start with Baselines for an agile product. It explains how a plan like this one gives executives something firm to approve and still leaves the team room to learn.

12 branches | 71 work packages | 58 weeks | 9 gates | 2026-10-27

What Phase 1 builds

Phase 1 is the first release: publish information, find it, and prove it is current and owned. Everything runs on departmental infrastructure with no outside connections.

Publish

A CMS with a government design system theme. One workflow carries English and French together. Every page has a named owner and a review date.

Find

A search engine with separate English and French indexes. One shared vocabulary runs through the site, search and analytics. A people directory comes from the identity feed.

Prove

A self-hosted analytics tool and content health reports. Video plays in the browser. Retired pages are archived to the records system after approval.

Existing content is migrated, not rebuilt. Nothing moves without an owner.

Roadmap

Four phases, twelve branches, nine gates. Dark bars are on the critical path: a delay there delays go-live. Light bars have float. Each gate is accepted against evidence, such as a working system, a test result or a signed authorization. Never against a progress report.

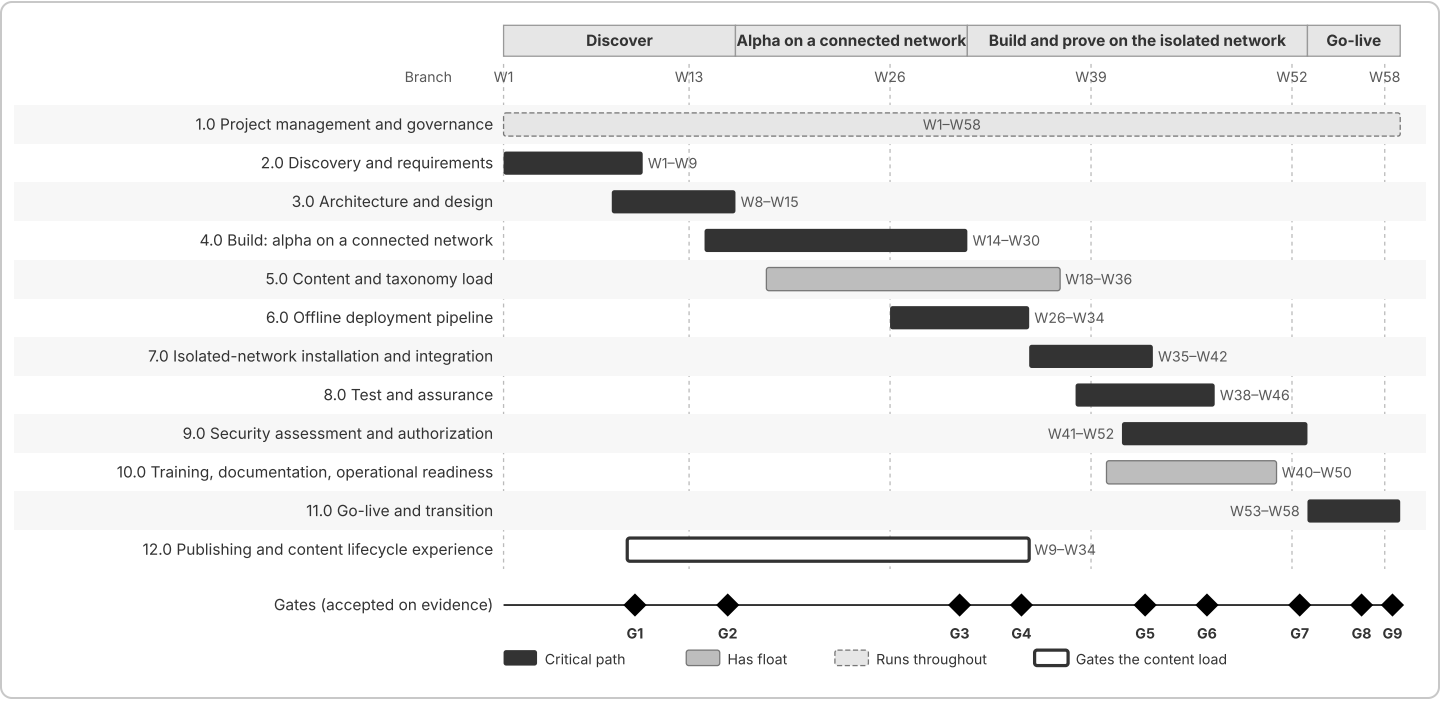


Figure 1: Phase 1 roadmap by week. Week 1 is the notional start. Everything shifts week for week with the real start.

The nine gates

Gate	Week	Accepted when
G1	W9	Requirements baseline accepted
G2	W15	Design signed off by architecture
G3	W30	Alpha accepted, stakeholders trained
G4	W34	Transfer artefacts and pipeline dry run accepted
G5	W42	Installed and integration-tested on the isolated network
G6	W46	Test and assurance complete
G7	W52	Authority to operate granted
G8	W56	Go-live
G9	W58	Hypercare complete, project closed

One rule for gate G6. Do not close testing until the bilingual parity report counts English and French separately. A combined pass rate can hide a stalled French queue. That is an official-languages exposure that only shows after go-live.

Storyboard

The same plan told through the people who use it, run it and own the content. Eight scenes, from the old site to the waves that follow go-live.

01 Today: an intranet nobody trusts

An employee needs the town hall video. Seven steps later, they may still not see it.

AS IS

7 steps

1. Click a link on the intranet
2. Land in the corporate document system
3. Sign in
4. Save the file
5. Find the file
6. Open it in a desktop player
7. Hope the right codec is installed

→

AT GO-LIVE

2 steps

1. Click the page
2. It plays in the browser, with captions in your language

One managed copy, with an owner and a review date. Views are measured.

The video is the visible symptom. Underneath it, pages have no named owner, nobody knows what is read, and nothing says when a page goes stale.

02 “One-stop shop” is four jobs

Each job costs a different amount. Phase 1 attacks one of them on purpose.

Find

I can locate information fast, in my language.

DIRECTLY ATTACKED

Know

I learn what changed without hunting for it.

PARTLY Current and owned. Nothing is pushed yet.

Do

I start my task: pay, leave, travel, an IT ticket.

BARELY Links only.

Connect

I can respond, ask, or contribute.

ONE CHANNEL “Was this useful?” on every page.

Why this order. Engagement features on stale content make the problem worse, because they advertise neglect. Fix the content first.

03 The road to go-live

Content moves before the doors open. When the new site goes live, the old one goes dark.

Discover

- Workshops: content, IT, security
- Shared taxonomy agreed
- Content audit and owner list
- Publishing tiers mocked up and agreed

Alpha on a connected network

- Core concepts only, no real data
- Teams trained on the real tools
- Migration patterns tried
- One and done

Isolated build

- Development and staging on the isolated network
- Content migrated to staging
- Security hardening, authorization
- Performance and accessibility checks

Go-live

- Final content cutover
- Old site switched off
- Owners, review dates and reports running
- Support in place

CONTENT MIGRATION THREAD

DISCOVER
Audit. Every page gets an owner or a retire decision.

ALPHA
Try the migration on sample pages.

ISOLATED BUILD
Migrate owned content to staging, English and French together.

GO-LIVE
Cut over. Nothing is carried for old bookmarks.

The rule: **nothing migrates without an owner**. The old site is not worth redirect work, so bookmarks are not preserved.

04 What go-live gives everyone

Six promises, all in scope for Phase 1.

Current and owned

- Owner and review date on every page
- Automatic keep, refresh or retire reminders
- Approved retirement archived as a record

Findable

- Separate English and French search indexes
- One vocabulary across site, search and analytics
- People directory from the identity feed
- Empty searches logged and reviewed

Bilingual, provably

- English and French measured separately, always
- A one-language page shows as a gap the same day
- No total can hide a stalled French queue

Automation

- Anything on a schedule is the system’s job
- Scheduled publish and unpublish
- One workflow for both languages
- Reports arrive by email

Transparency

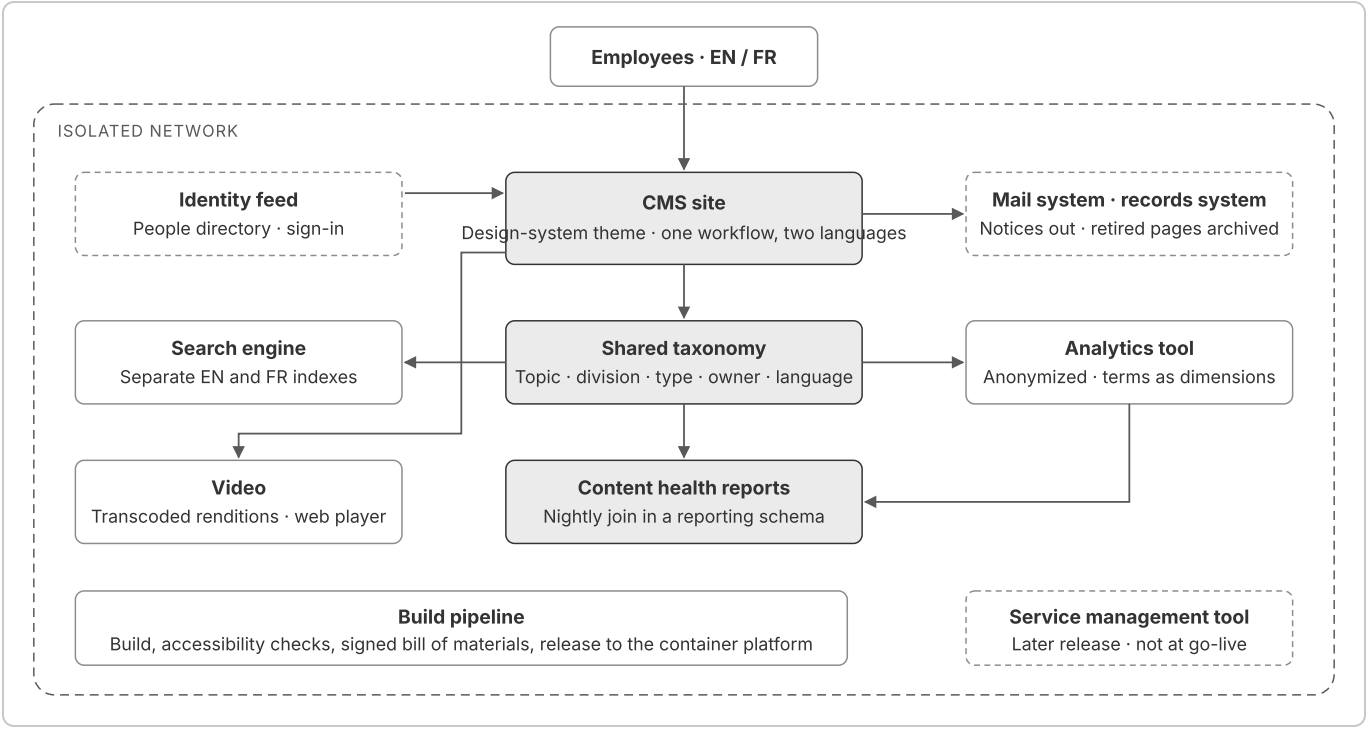
- Readership on the page, for its publisher
- Executives see if a message was read, by language
- The same numbers for everyone

Accessibility

- Accessible by construction, from design-system components
- Checked at build and again on the live site
- Open findings counted per language

05 The minimum platform underneath

Everything runs inside the isolated network. No cloud, no content delivery network, no outside calls.



Dashed boxes belong to other teams. The shared taxonomy sits in the middle on purpose. Terms are applied once, by the author, and search, analytics and reports all inherit them. Get the vocabulary wrong in the first workshops and every one of them inherits the mistake.

06 Who wins at go-live

Seven groups. Each gets something on day one, and each has a moment that proves it.

Group	In their words	Gets at go-live	Grows later
Communications	“I can see every page that needs review, and the system chases owners for me.”	Bilingual publishing, tiered approval, content health reports, scheduled publishing	Review queue and flag screens; a monthly search gap backlog
Content owners	“I get a reminder when my page is due. Keep, refresh or retire, and I’m done.”	Named ownership, review dates, notices that carry no content, only a link	“My content” page with readership and usefulness per page
Information management	“Retired pages arrive in the records system as one bilingual record.”	Automatic archiving on approval; one managed copy of each video	12 months of traffic beside every retire decision
Security	“Every release comes with a signed list of what is inside it.”	Everything as code, a signed bill of materials, no cloud design tools	A named owner per component; offline advisory checks

Group	In their words	Gets at go-live	Grows later
IT operations	“No hand deploys. If it isn’t in the pipeline, it isn’t in production.”	One pipeline from build to the isolated network, on a container platform	The same platform reused for later integrations
Employees	“I searched in French and got French results, and the video just played.”	Fast bilingual search, current pages, a people directory, in-browser video	Trust signals in search; services, training, “while you were away”
Executives	“I can see whether my message was read, and in which language.”	Readership per message by language; the same numbers everyone sees	Year 2: is search working? Year 3: did people get the task done?

07 What we say first

Some things staff lose or do not get. Better they hear it from us.

Not in this release

- Nothing is pushed: no digests or notifications to staff
- No transactions: pay, leave and IT requests are links
- No targeted announcements or follow-a-topic
- No personalization, no mobile
- Live streams link out to the existing platform

Ruled out, not deferred

- Open discussion forums: moderation, language and records risk
- Wiki-style co-editing: a page everyone edits is a page nobody owns
- A separate engagement platform: another system to secure and run, outside the ownership model

08 After go-live: each wave moves a job

The data is collected from day one. Each wave asks a better question of it, or adds one job.

Wave 1

`Phase 1 increment`

PROPOSED

- “My content” for owners
- Owner and review date beside each search result
- Monthly owner nudges and a search gap report
- “Retire with confidence”

Strengthens **Find** and **Know**: owners act, and staff can tell current from stale.

Wave 2
`Later release`

LATER

- Service catalogue sync from the service management tool
- Services found in the same search as content
- “My tasks”, near real time
- Calendar availability beside people

Moves **Do** from links to found services.

Wave 3
`Year 2`

LATER

- “While you were away” on the home page
- Training catalogue indexed beside content
- Related pages from shared terms
- Role-based views
- Captions drafted by a local AI service

Moves **Know**: change finds you.

Wave 4
`Year 3`

LATER

- Task success measured, not just visits
- “Did this answer your question?” feeds outcome reports
- Search and content tuned from the evidence

Needs new work. Phase 1 only collects the data.

Analytics follows the same path: year 1 asks whether the site is used and healthy, year 2 reads the same data better (is search working?), and year 3 asks whether people got the task done.

Concepts

Concepts are ideas that start a conversation. Only the first group, the mock-up set, is proposed Phase 1 scope. The rest are not committed. Each depends on skilled people being in place, such as a content manager, a taxonomy steward, a designer and a developer. Until those posts are filled, the ideas have no owner.

PROPOSED Mock-ups for the publishing and lifecycle experience

Nobody agrees a publishing authority model in the abstract. People argue until they see a screen. These eight mock-ups settle who approves what, with Communications and two business lines, before the build packages start.

#	Screen	The question it answers
1	**“My content” owner dashboard**	What does accountability look like on a Tuesday morning?
2	**Communications review queue**	Can a small team carry review after publication? What does two days of work look like?
3	**Flag and escalation**	Is “comment, correct by date, unpublish” proportionate, or does it feel punitive?
4	**Publish screen, blocked**	Is the guardrail helpful or infuriating? Does it say what to do next?
5	**Tier indicator**	How does an author know, before writing, who approves this?
6	**Review-date decision**	Is there enough evidence to decide, or will everyone press “keep”?
7	**Retire and archive confirmation**	Does the irreversible step feel safe enough to take?
8	**“While you were away” digest**	Does the site give something back to the people who maintain it?

What a mock-up must show to be useful: both languages side by side (French runs 15 to 30 percent longer); real content, including stale pages; the unhappy path, such as a page with no owner or a French version never written; realistic volume, because 6 pages look fine and 300 are a different product; and keyboard and screen-reader behaviour, even at concept stage.

Where they live: clickable HTML prototypes built on the design system and hosted inside the network. Cloud design tools would put content and structure outside the network. Prototypes must not become the build. They have no caching, no permissions and no tests. Reuse the markup and the pattern, not the code.

Ideas for later

IDEA “What changed while I was away”

An employee returns from three weeks of leave. The home page says what changed in their areas, what videos were posted, and what they own that needs attention.

> **Welcome back. You were away 12 days.**
>
> 4 updated pages in your areas (Leave, Telework) · 2 new videos, including the Q3 town hall · 1 page you own is due for review

Built from the CMS, not the analytics tool, which stays anonymized. The panel loads separately from the cached page.

IDEA The site changes through the day

Mornings want news and notices. Midday is for tasks. Late in the day there is room for learning. Three time bands means three cached versions of the home page, not one per person. Test with analytics first: if traffic does not shift by time of day, the idea does not earn its keep.

IDEA Search that shows whether a page can be trusted

Each result shows its owner and when it was last reviewed, so staff can tell current guidance from stale before clicking. A one-question “Did this answer your question?” turns search into a measure of task success.

> **Search: parental leave**
>
> Parental leave: how to apply · How-to · HR · **Reviewed 2 months ago**
> Leave: planning your time off · Guidance · HR · **Review due**

Owner and review date are already Phase 1 fields. Showing them in results is a small step.

PROPOSED

“My content”: owners see how their pages are doing

An owner opens one page and sees everything they publish: readers in each language, how people found each page, whether it was useful, and what is due for review. No request to IT, no waiting for a report. This one became load-bearing: notices carry no content, only a pointer, so this screen is the whole experience.

My content · Benefits team · last 30 days (sample numbers)

Page	Views EN / FR	From search	Useful	Review
Parental leave: how to apply	1,240 / 410	64%	88%	Reviewed 2 months ago
Leave: planning your time off	860 / 295	51%	79%	Review due
Dental plan changes (old)	42 / 9	12%	–	**Overdue**

One page is overdue and almost unread, so it is a candidate to retire. Retiring is the owner’s decision. Nothing is removed automatically.

The data already exists in Phase 1: analytics visits and CMS metadata joined nightly. Figures are aggregate. No individual reader is shown.

IDEA

Success-based dashboard for Communications

One view that answers “is the intranet healthy?”: ownership, freshness, parity and findability, with a drill-down by division. Phase 1 delivers the data through content health reporting. This idea is the presentation layer on top.

Also on the board: monthly owner nudges by email, and “retire with confidence”, which shows 12 months of traffic and the searches that led to a page before it is removed.

Work breakdown structure

12 branches and 71 work packages. A heavy border marks a branch on the critical path. A double border marks the branch that is not on the chain but gates the content load. Each branch lists its packages and weeks; use the summary line to fold one away.

Intranet, first release — 12 branches · 71 work packages

1.0 Project management and governance

W1–W58 · Delivery lead and PMO

Runs throughout, has float · 4 packages

- 1.1 Charter, project plan, baselined schedule
  W1–W3
- 1.2 Governance and reporting cadence
  W1–W58
- 1.3 Risk, issue and change management
  W1–W58
- 1.4 Gate acceptance against evidence
  W9–W58

2.0 Discovery and requirements

W1–W9 · Business and delivery team

On the critical path · 5 packages

- 2.1 Content architecture workshops (structure, taxonomy)
  W2–W4
- 2.2 IT architecture and environment workshops
  W3–W5
- 2.3 Security, privacy and authorization path
  W4–W6
- 2.4 Accessibility and official-languages requirements
  W5–W6
- 2.5 Requirements baseline and traceability matrix
  W7–W9

3.0 Architecture and design

W8–W15 · Delivery team

On the critical path · 8 packages

- 3.1 Design conformance to architecture constraints
  W8–W11
- 3.2 Shared taxonomy model (CMS, search, analytics)
  W8–W12
- 3.3 CMS site architecture (workflow, archive renderings)
  W9–W12
- 3.4 Design-system theme and custom component plan
  W10–W13
- 3.5 Search design (separate English and French indexes)
  W10–W13
- 3.6 Analytics design (freshness and ownership)
  W11–W14
- 3.7 Offline build and environment design
  W12–W14
- 3.8 Design review and architecture sign-off
  W15

4.0
Build: alpha on a connected network
W14–W30 · Delivery team
On the critical path · 11 packages

4.1 Alpha environment provisioning
W14–W16

4.2 CMS install
W16–W19

4.3 Theme and custom component build (self-hosted assets)
W17–W22

4.4 Content types, taxonomy, workflow, translation
W19–W24

4.5 Search integration and English/French indexing
W22–W26

4.10 Video pipeline: transcoding, player, captions, play tracking
W22–W27

4.6 Analytics install and instrumentation
W24–W27

4.11 People directory: identity feed
W24–W28

4.7 Content health pipeline (freshness, ownership)
W25–W29

4.9 Records-system archive integration
W26–W29

4.8 Alpha acceptance and stakeholder upskilling
W28–W30

5.0
Content and taxonomy load
W18–W36 · Communications
Has float · 5 packages

5.1 Content inventory and disposition
W18–W23

5.2 Named owner and owning branch for every page
W20–W25

5.3 Apply taxonomy; metadata quality checks
W24–W30

5.4 English/French parity validation
W26–W33

5.5 Migration dry runs
W31–W36

6.0
Offline deployment pipeline
W26–W34 · Delivery team and IT
On the critical path · 4 packages

6.1 Mirror dependencies (package registries, operating system)
W26–W29

6.2 Artefact packaging, manifest and signing
W28–W31

6.3 Transfer process and media handling
W30–W32

6.4 End-to-end pipeline dry run (connected to isolated network)
W32–W34

7.0
Isolated-network installation and integration
W35–W42 · Delivery team and IT
On the critical path · 5 packages

7.1 Target environment readiness and hand-off
W35–W36

7.2 Install, configure and harden
W36–W39

7.3 Integration and smoke testing
W39–W40

7.4 Performance, load and failover testing
W40–W41

7.5 Backup and restore verification
W41–W42

8.0
Test and assurance
W38–W46 · Business and delivery team
On the critical path · 5 packages

8.1 Functional testing and user acceptance
W38–W42

8.2 Accessibility: automated checks plus manual assistive-technology audit
W40–W44

8.3 Bilingual parity testing (English and French separately)
W40–W44

8.4 Security testing (scan, penetration test)
W41–W44

8.5 Defect triage and resolution
W42–W46

9.0
Security assessment and authorization
W41–W52 · Security
On the critical path · 4 packages

9.1 Security artefacts (security plan, threat and risk, privacy inputs)
W41–W45

9.2 Security control assessment
W45–W49

9.3 Remediation of findings
W48–W51

9.4 Authorization decision
W52

10.0
Training, documentation, operational readiness
W40–W50 · Delivery team and business
Has float · 4 packages

10.1 Operations runbooks and admin documentation
W40–W45

10.2 Content author training (English and French)
W44–W48

10.3 Analytics training by audience
W46–W49

10.4 Service transition to operations
W47–W50

11.0
Go-live and transition
W53–W58 · Business and delivery team
On the critical path · 4 packages

11.1 Go / no-go review and cutover plan
W53–W54

11.2 Cutover and launch
W55–W56

11.3 Hypercare
W56–W58

11.4 Warranty start and project closeout
W58

12.0
Publishing and content lifecycle experience

W9–W34 · Delivery team and Communications

Not on the chain, but gates the content load · 12 packages

12.1 Editorial workflow and publishing authority model
W9–W13

12.2 Authoring guardrails: language gate, metadata, taxonomy, accessibility at save
W11–W14

12.12 Concepts and mock-ups
W12–W18

12.3 “My content” owner and author dashboard
W20–W26

12.8 Scheduling, embargo and bilingual preview
W21–W25

12.4 Communications review queue and sampling
W21–W27

12.6 Owner of record and delegation (owner by position)
W22–W26

12.5 Flag and escalation: comment, correct-by-date, unpublish
W22–W28

12.10 Audit trail and compliance evidence
W24–W28

12.7 Review, reminder and escalation engine
W24–W29

12.9 Disposition journey to the records system: screens and approvals
W26–W29

12.11 Publisher and owner training and guidance, per tier
W28–W34

Why branch 12.0 exists. Publishing experience used to be spread across the design, build and content branches with no single owner. That is the gap where a good author experience and Communications’ control get traded off by accident. Packages 12.1, 12.2 and 12.12 must be accepted before the content load starts at week 18, because inventory and owner assignment are made against the publishing authority model. If that model changes afterwards, every ownership decision re-opens.

Critical path and dependencies

2.0 Discovery → **3.0 Design** → **4.0 Alpha build** → **6.0 Pipeline** → **7.0 Install** → **8.0 Test** → **9.0 Authorization** → **11.0 Go-live**

Content load (5.0) and training (10.0) run alongside and carry float. The content load feeds user testing though. Slip it past week 36 and it joins the critical path.

Must finish first	Before this starts	Why
2.5 Requirements baseline	3.1 Design	No design without agreed scope
3.8 Architecture sign-off	4.2 CMS build	Prevents rework
3.2 Taxonomy model	4.4, 4.5, 4.6 Content, search, analytics	The same vocabulary must reach the CMS, search and analytics
4.1 Alpha environment	4.2 onward	Hard gate on a dependency outside the delivery team
6.4 Pipeline dry run	7.2 Install	Proves no outside dependency remains
7.5 Restore verification	8.1 Acceptance testing	Test on a recoverable system
8.5 Defects closed	9.2 Control assessment	Assess a stable build
9.4 Authorization decision	11.2 Launch	Cannot go live unauthorized
12.12 Mock-ups agreed	12.1, 12.2 acceptance	Tier boundaries are tested against screens before they are built
12.1, 12.2 accepted	5.1 Content inventory (week 18)	Owners are assigned against the publishing authority model

Scope

In scope for Phase 1

- CMS built on its core, no distribution
- Design-system theme, assets self-hosted
- Bilingual publishing, parity measured per language
- Search with separate English and French indexes
- Self-hosted analytics, plus content freshness and ownership reporting
- Video playback in the browser, with captions
- People directory from the identity feed
- Automated archiving of retired pages to the records system, after owner and publisher approval
- Offline build pipeline, alpha on a connected network, isolated-network install, authorization, go-live

Out of scope, later release candidates

- Service catalogue batch sync
- “My tasks”, near real time
- Personalization and role-based targeting
- A BI tool as the content health surface

These are sized into the platform so it does not need rework later.

Back to the baselines

This plan is the concrete side of the baselines: the scope boundary, the roadmap with its gates, and the funding envelope that narrows as each gate is passed.

Baselines for an agile product: what executives can expect, and how funding follows

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Drafted with Claude.ai from a private project hub, then generalized. Product, team and system names are removed on purpose. Weeks, not dates, so the plan holds whatever the real start.